

Chapter 88 - High Fever

The two walked all the way to the storage cabin door. Yan Lin put down the snowboard and struggled through the thick snow to push open the cabin door.

The storage cabin was a very small room, probably only about five or six square meters, pitch black inside, and they didn't know if there were any lights.

Yan Lin stood at the doorway and used her phone's flashlight to illuminate the inside, confirming there was no danger before turning back to drag Feng Yue's snowboard again.

It wasn't until Yan Lin closed the storage cabin door again, blocking out the raging wind and snow, that the heavy stone in Feng Yue's heart finally settled.

Feng Yue took out her phone to check the time—it was almost ten o'clock at night. They had walked in the wind and snow for a full three hours.

Feng Yue turned on her phone's flashlight and was about to call Yan Lin to sit down and rest when she heard the sound of something heavy hitting the ground.

Feng Yue's heart tightened, and she instinctively looked toward Yan Lin. "Yan Lin! What's wrong?!" By the light of her flashlight, Feng Yue finally saw what had happened.

Yan Lin had collapsed to the ground and was breathing heavily, looking like she was having trouble breathing.

Feng Yue panicked a bit. At this moment, she couldn't care about her own leg injury and quickly crawled over. When her palm touched Yan Lin's cheek, she felt the scalding temperature coming from her body.

Yan Lin had a fever.

Instantly, Feng Yue's face became very ugly. She shone the light on Yan Lin's face and saw her nearly frozen hat brim and flushed cheeks—whether red from fever or cold, she couldn't tell.

"Yan Lin, Yan Lin! How are you? Are you uncomfortable somewhere?" Feng Yue took off her hat, which was almost soaked by snow water and frozen, then took off her outer coat and the dry sweater underneath, using the sweater to wipe Yan Lin's wet hair and face.

The storage cabin had no windows for ventilation, and the only exit was a single door. Although it blocked the wind and snow outside, the extremely low temperature still made Feng Yue shiver all over.

She didn't know when Yan Lin had started running a fever, but at least before they came in, when she saw her stiff back figure, her condition was already wrong.

They could probably walk here only relying on Yan Lin's inner persistence and mechanical instinct.

Yan Lin was now almost delirious with fever. If they let Yan Lin continue with a high fever, the consequences would be unthinkable.

The stone that had settled in Feng Yue's heart was suspended again. She took a deep breath and tried hard to regulate her emotions.

It's okay, as long as they get through tonight, as long as the snow stops, they will definitely be rescued.

Feng Yue gave herself psychological preparation before picking up her phone and using her ski pole to support herself, starting to search for useful items in the storage cabin.

There was a shelf in the storage cabin with some food on it. Except for a pack of compressed biscuits, everything else had turned into ice blocks. Even the clean water had frozen solid because the temperature was too low and it had been sitting for a while.

Feng Yue hopped on one foot to search through some corners, and besides some empty cardboard boxes, she also found a somewhat worn sleeping bag, several candles, and a lighter.

Seeing the lighter, Feng Yue's heart filled with wild joy. Being able to see a fire source in this icy world was tremendous luck for her.

Feng Yue dismantled all the empty cardboard boxes and spread them flat on the ground, then dragged Yan Lin to lie down on them, finally spreading the sleeping bag over Yan Lin.

After doing all this, she took out the precious candles and lighter and placed them in front of them.

When the candle's weak flame illuminated this small corner of the world, Feng Yue's nose tingled and she sighed in relief.

When Yan Lin regained consciousness and felt moisture on her lips as she opened her eyes, what she saw was the candlelight placed in front of her.

And she was currently lying on Feng Yue's shoulder.

Yan Lin couldn't stand the itchy feeling in her throat and coughed a few times. Feng Yue paused her movements, then put down the water bottle in her hand. "Yan Lin? You're awake? Are you uncomfortable anywhere?"

Yan Lin endured the dizzy feeling from her brain and really wanted to tell Feng Yue that she was uncomfortable everywhere, but in the end she gently shook her head and uttered one syllable: "No..."

Hearing her voice, Feng Yue's whole body seemed to lose strength as she leaned against the wall. Then she handed the partially melted water bottle to Yan Lin's lips. "Drink some water, although there isn't much."

Yan Lin half-opened her eyes, looking at Feng Yue's fingers that were red from cold, and struggled to lift her arm to hold the other's hand with one hand. An icy, bone-piercing chill traveled from her palm to her heart.

"I'm fine now... you drink it..." Yan Lin didn't need to think to know how this bottle of water had been melted.

Feng Yue thought she was complaining about the small amount of water in the bottle, so she pressed her lips together and put the bottle down, then took the compressed biscuits beside her and brought them to Yan Lin. "Then eat something. You're running a fever and probably don't have much strength. Eating something might make you feel better."

Yan Lin watched Feng Yue unwrap the compressed biscuits and bring them to her lips, saying, "This is all we can eat right now. Everything else has frozen into ice blocks. The biscuits might not taste very good, but please eat some."

"You eat first." Yan Lin pushed her hand, hoping she would eat first.

"I'm not hungry, you eat quickly." As soon as Feng Yue finished speaking, her stomach made a protesting sound.

Embarrassment spread through the quiet little room, and then Feng Yue heard Yan Lin's soft laughter.

Yan Lin's tone contained a hint of indulgence as she pushed Feng Yue's wrist. "You eat first. You probably don't want to eat my leftovers, right?"

Feng Yue hadn't thought of this, but now that Yan Lin mentioned it, she couldn't pretend she hadn't heard. She had no choice but to lower her head and take a bite of the compressed biscuit.

The taste of compressed biscuits really couldn't be called delicious, but right now they had nothing else to eat besides this.

The two shared the pack of compressed biscuits with the very limited ice water.

But after eating, Yan Lin somehow triggered some switch and began coughing violently.

At first, Feng Yue thought she had choked, but later when she saw Yan Lin coughing and then starting to dry heave, she realized this was probably a complication caused by the high fever.

The coughing fit seemed to drain all the little strength Yan Lin had just accumulated. Her whole face flushed red as she leaned on Feng Yue's shoulder, breathing hard like a dying fish.

Feng Yue watched her close her eyes and was about to fall asleep, and suddenly became anxious.

Yan Lin couldn't sleep now. It was deep into the night and the temperature was getting lower and lower. If the two of them just fell asleep in this room, they might be the ones frozen into popsicles tomorrow morning.

"Yan Lin, Yan Lin! Don't sleep! You can't sleep! If you sleep, you really won't wake up!" Feng Yue was also shivering from cold. She also really wanted to close her eyes and rest, but she couldn't.

Yan Lin had insisted on bringing them both here despite her high fever, just so they could be successfully rescued the next day.

Now that Yan Lin had lost her ability to act, she should take on all the responsibility.

Yan Lin only felt her brain was as heavy as her eyelids, but she could always hear Feng Yue's familiar voice in her ears. Her tired brain could even distinguish the fear and panic in Feng Yue's tone.

What's wrong with A Yue? Is someone bullying her?

She had to protect A Yue. She needed to open her eyes and see what was happening.

"Yan Lin, don't sleep! I beg you, I beg you!" Feng Yue was like a person abandoned by the world on an isolated island. Fear and panic swept over that island like a tsunami, drowning her in it.

"I'll talk with you. Don't sleep. If you fall asleep, you'll never wake up again." Feng Yue's eyes were red as she held Yan Lin's arm and kept shaking her.

But no matter what Feng Yue said, Yan Lin didn't respond. She quietly leaned on Feng Yue's shoulder, with only weak breathing proving she was still alive.

"Yan Lin, A Lin, don't sleep. Please talk with me, I beg you..." Feng Yue's voice carried a crying tone, like an ordinary person praying for divine intervention, begging for Yan Lin to pull herself together and talk with her.

A tear silently welled up from Feng Yue's eyes, then slid down her cheek and fell from her chin.

Feng Yue's tone gradually became restless and anxious, and her words became desperate: "A Lin, don't sleep. We can talk about anything, as long as you don't sleep, okay?"

At this point, Feng Yue seemed to grasp at a life-saving straw, her tone somewhat excited: "Don't you want to know my secret? I'll tell you, I'll tell you everything! As long as you don't sleep, I'll tell you everything!"

More and more tears fell from Feng Yue's face like broken pearls, all dropping onto Yan Lin's hand.

When Yan Lin struggled to open her eyes, wanting to see clearly who was bullying her A Yue, what she heard and saw was this almost desperate scene of Feng Yue.

"A Yue... don't be afraid..." Yan Lin propped up her heavy eyelids and lifted her hand to pat Feng Yue's hand.

Hearing Yan Lin's voice, Feng Yue immediately came back to her senses. She sniffled and quickly said, "You're awake! That's great. Don't sleep. I'll talk with you. Please don't sleep."

Yan Lin didn't know why she was so excited, but she just nodded and said, "Speak... I won't sleep."

Feng Yue pulled herself together and wiped away her tears. "Okay, I'll tell you, I'll tell you everything. As long as you don't sleep, I'll tell you anything."

Both of them weren't very clearheaded right now—one hadn't heard what Feng Yue said before, and the other didn't understand what Yan Lin had said.

But Feng Yue obviously couldn't think about so much now. She just hoped Yan Lin would stay awake. As long as she stayed awake, she could say anything.

"Haven't you always wanted to know why I'm so certain that I'll die on May 4th, just like in my previous life?"

Yan Lin's brain, which had been struggling to stay awake, turned this sentence around several times before understanding its meaning. The moment she understood, her half-closed eyes tried to open wider.

"Because that's how it's written in the book¹, and we are just characters in the book, at the mercy of others."

Footnotes:

1. "The book" - Feng Yue is referring to the novel she discovered that apparently contains her life story, suggesting their reality might be fictional or predetermined